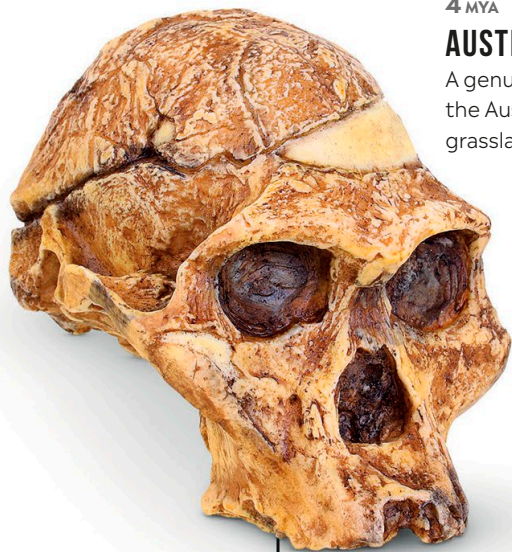


4 MYA

AUSTRALOPITHECINES FLOURISH

A genus of early hominins capable of walking upright, the Australopithecines, began to thrive on the grasslands of Africa.

◁ Replica *Australopithecus africanus* skull, named "Mrs Ples"



1.9 MYA

USE OF SPECIALIZED TOOLS

Homo erectus ("upright man"), a descendant of the Australopithecines, evolved. Recognizably different from the earlier ape-like ancestors of humans, *Homo erectus* developed the skill of chipping stone to make sophisticated cutting and hunting tools, and about one million years ago learned how to make and use fire.



△ Stone hand-axe of the lower Palaeolithic

4 MYA

2.5 MYA *Homo habilis* emerges and uses simple stone tools

300 KYA *Homo sapiens*, the first modern humans, appear in Africa

▽ Fossilized headless remains of a young Neanderthal man



400 KYA

NEANDERTHALS APPEAR

Neanderthals, named after the Neander Valley in Germany where they were discovered in 1856, first began to appear in Europe and Asia. They were well adapted to the colder climate of the north, and flourished there until about 40 KYA. Contrary to popular belief, the Neanderthals were intelligent and inventive, and as well as being skilled toolmakers, made clothes and footwear, and had a culture that included burial of the dead.